

After the fight, pause before you repeat the pattern.

Sometimes the same small disagreements keep happening even when you both want things to be different. Take five minutes to pause, reflect on what happened, and understand what may have been underneath the moment before you talk about it together.

A

WHAT HAPPENED?

From my perspective, what happened?

B

WHAT DID IT BRING UP FOR ME?

What was I feeling underneath my reaction?

- ☐ Hurt ☐ Unheard ☐ Unimportant ☐ Rejected
☐ Alone ☐ Frustrated ☐ Disappointed ☐ Overwhelmed

Something else:

C

WHAT DID I ACTUALLY NEED?

What was I hoping my partner would understand, notice, or do?

D

BEFORE WE CONTINUE...

What do I want my partner to understand about my experience?

What do I want my partner to understand about my experience?

What is one thing I want to understand about my partner's experience?

ONE SMALL STEP FORWARD

What could we do differently the next time this pattern starts?

Pause. Understand. Then talk.

Complete this reflection individually first, then share what feels helpful with each other.